



Gentle giants

In the forest of Rwanda's Volcanoes National Park, a young mountain gorilla lies in the safety of its mother's arms. Of all the great apes, mountain gorillas are the largest, but they are among the world's rarest mammals, with fewer than 800 individuals surviving in the wild. Mountain gorillas have a slow breeding rate—females give birth to a single baby every three to four years. Gorillas grow up slowly as well. This youngster will stay close to its mother until her next baby arrives, learning vital life skills such as which plants to eat, or how to build a nest in the trees for sleeping.